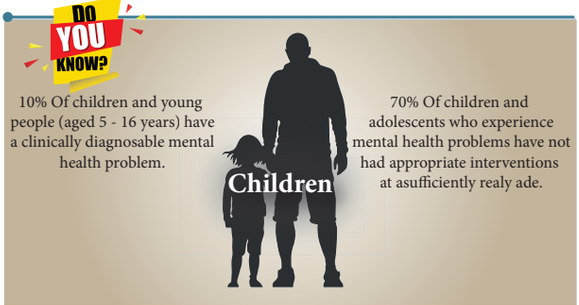
3.6.1 Mental health

3.6.1.1 Definition of Mental health

- It is "the adjustment of human beings to the world and to each other with maximum of effectiveness and happiness" **Meninger**
- Mental health includes our emotional, psychological, and social well-being. It affects how we think, feel, and act. It also helps to determine how we handle stress, relate to others, and make choices.
- Mental health can be "conceptualized as a state of well-being in which the individual realizes his or her own abilities, can cope with the normal stresses of life, can work productively and fruitfully, and is able to make a contribution to his or her community." (The World Health Organisation (WHO) 2001).



Myth: Mental health problems don't affect me.
Fact- Mental health problems are very common. In 2014, about:
One in five American adults experienced a mental health issue
One in 10 young people experienced a period of major depression
One in 25 Americans lived with a serious mental illness, such as schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, or major depression.
Suicide is the 10th leading cause of death in the United States. It accounts for the loss of more than 41,000 American lives each year, more than double the number of lives lost to homicide.

In India according to National health survey 2015

• **45 % of Indian population are suffering from depression**
• **871 suicide are happening daily in an average**
• **Suicide is the second leading cause of death in 18-29 age group**
• **150 millions are in need of active treatment**
• **Anxiety disorders and substance abuse are affecting 10 % of the population**

3.6.2 Characteristics of mentally healthy person

The mentally healthy person will be (refer picture)

- Free from internal conflict
- Searches for an identity
- Has strong sense of self esteem and self confident
- Knows his needs, problems and goals and solves problems
- Has good control over his behavior
- Productive
- Satisfied with profession and occupation

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